MULTIMEDIA12 · NIGHT SHIFT · TWO-VIDEO WORKSHOP

Understand the illusion. Then build your own.

A visual, step-by-step teaching sequence from skull placement to masks, flesh, texture, colour and final light.

24 illustrated stages | Timestamped videos | 24 teaching stages | Draft preview

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 10:18

Finished reference by Benny Productions: study the integrated colour, form and surface detail.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

START HERE

A convincing character. A method you can explain.

This workshop turns the two supplied videos into a slower teaching sequence. Follow Benny's portrait method, compare Learning Screen's bark treatment, then make your own choices. This page is the character-compositing workshop; the full photography/poster/3D project remains a separate classroom resource.

> **Draft · public video edition.** The 24-stage lesson uses the creators' official timestamped players. Internet is needed for demonstrations. The full manual Photoshop walkthrough, independent cold run and assessment-system connections remain open. This is a teaching preview.

CLIENT	A fictional school film-festival campaign.
AUDIENCE	Teen viewers; theatrical fiction, with the teacher-approved level of detail.
YOUR JOB	Create an editable character treatment with one focal effect. Keep the person recognisable and make light/material consistent.
START WITH	Your own approved portrait, the supplied CC0 skull source, and your own or teacher-provided approved material photographs. No cloud upload is required.

Download the practice assets CC0 skull included. Paint/food/portrait photos are supplied by your teacher or chosen from your own approved sources. Start the visual foundation Print this workshop

The CC0 alternative skull lacks a separate lower jaw. It supports the core nose/socket/upper-bone route; the advanced external-jaw extension needs a suitable full-jaw source. Original video assets are not assumed to be available or licensed for redistribution.

The full Night Shift project remains with your teacher. This public preview adds no assignment, Form or automatic submission route.

PRODUCTION CONNECTION

What a compositor is solving.

Different photographs must appear to share a camera, a surface and a light source. Judge alignment, scale, edges, focus, value and colour. A saved stack is useful because clients request changes; the edit needs to survive revision.

MUST UNDERSTAND

Match the problem to the control.

Problem	Control	What changes?
Feature is in the wrong place	Transform / restrained Warp	Position, scale, angle or shape
Photo shows in the wrong region	Layer mask	Local visibility
Tones should interact	Blend If	Visibility/blending based on a brightness test
Correction spills onto other layers	Clipping relationship	Which source/group supplies the boundary
Material is too bright or colourful	Clipped tonal/colour correction	Value or colour, without solving bad alignment
Edge looks detached	Mask, contact light/shadow, sharpness match	The overlap relationship

Before touching a control: predict what you expect to see. Then make one change and compare.

I CAN / SUCCESS

What you should be able to do.

- I can align a source to the intended facial structure.
- I can explain and demonstrate the difference between a mask, Blend If, a blend mode and clipping.
- I can match material scale, edge, value, colour and focus.
- I can diagnose one mismatch, test a correction and show what changed.
- I can apply the method to a changed source/brief while preserving editable evidence.

Success: the final image communicates the intended character; it has one clear focal area and coherent light/material; the PSD retains named masks and corrections; you can defend your choices without reading the steps. Tutorial checkmarks are practice, not grades.

Assessment route: this workshop adds no registered task or grade. Use the existing Night Shift assignment and its selected character/poster route; official outcome/Forms connections remain with the full package and are not certified by this page.

SESSION 1 · LESSONS 1

Foundation and the bone reveal

Four short technique stages; pause for practice and repair before adding the next effect. Timing is an unmeasured teaching estimate, not a tested classroom duration.

01 Plan the illusion before adding effects

Start here: read or listen to the theory deck (about 10 minutes, with checkpoint questions), then come back.

Source-demonstrated method; classroom directions below are an adaptation for your own image. Current installed-version click-by-click verification remains open.

DOCUMENT: Your layered NightShift portrait PSD
SELECT: Your portrait and the two finished references
TOOLS / ROUTE: View the reference → choose one focal area

1. Compare the original portrait with the finished source result. Point to changes in shape, light–dark value, colour and surface texture. Decide which change attracts your eye first.
2. Plan one main effect and one supporting effect for your own portrait. Keep the person recognisable. Save the untouched photograph and work in a separately named layered PSD.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 0:34

Before: the unmodified portrait.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 10:18

After: the source creator's finished portrait, not a Codex production.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

WHY

A convincing composite uses consistent shape, light and material. Adding every available effect usually weakens the focal point.

CHECK

You can name the focal area, the intended audience and two visible changes before opening a filter.

FIX

If your plan is only "make it scary", identify the precise facial area and the material/light change you want.

Method basis: B. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

02 Protect the portrait and refine its silhouette

Source-demonstrated method; classroom directions below are an adaptation for your own image. Current installed-version click-by-click verification remains open.

DOCUMENT: Your layered NightShift portrait PSD
SELECT: Your portrait PSD · portrait layer and its mask
TOOLS / ROUTE: Layer → Smart Objects → Convert to Smart Object; Select → Select and Mask

1. Duplicate your portrait layer and keep the original hidden and locked. Name the working layer SUBJECT. Make a subject selection and add a layer mask; refine the hair and clothing edge in Select and Mask.
2. Add a Solid Color fill below SUBJECT as a temporary background. Inspect the outline against a light and a dark background. Correct the mask, then save the PSD.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 0:47

The video checks an edge close up.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 0:51

The source works on the Main Image layer mask. The 2019 interface differs from the current desktop layout.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

WHY

A clean silhouette and preserved original make later edits reversible.

CHECK

The background is separate; the person has no obvious cut-off hair or bright halo.

FIX

Paint on the mask thumbnail, not the photograph. White reveals; black hides. Restore accidentally hidden edges with white.

Method basis: B. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

03 Align the skull to facial landmarks

Source-demonstrated method; classroom directions below are an adaptation for your own image. Current installed-version click-by-click verification remains open.

DOCUMENT: Your layered NightShift portrait PSD
SELECT: Portrait PSD · SKULL Smart Object
TOOLS / ROUTE: File → Place Embedded; Edit → Free Transform

1. Create a SUBJECT BUILD group for the working subject and its effects; keep the protected original outside it. Place the skull above SUBJECT inside the group, name it SKULL and lower its opacity temporarily. Align the eye sockets, nose and mouth with the portrait; prioritise the area you will actually reveal.
2. Commit the transform with the checkmark, then return SKULL to100% opacity. The included CC0 skull is a different photograph and lacks a separate lower jaw: use it for the core eye/nose/upper-bone study. Its black background must be hidden with its mask or This Layer's dark Blend If control.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 1:15

Temporary transparency makes the two sets of facial landmarks visible.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 1:19

The creator restores layer opacity after alignment.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

WHY

Opacity helps placement; the final material is controlled by masks and blending, rather than permanent transparency.

CHECK

The intended bone feature follows the same eye/nose direction as the person, with no doubled landmarks in the revealed region.

FIX

If both eyes cannot align without severe distortion, choose a skull angle closer to the portrait or reveal a smaller area.

Method basis: B. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

04 Understand the two Blend If rows

Source-demonstrated method; classroom directions below are an adaptation for your own image. Current installed-version click-by-click verification remains open.

DOCUMENT: Your layered NightShift portrait PSD
SELECT: Portrait PSD · SKULL layer, not its mask
TOOLS / ROUTE: Layer → Layer Style → Blending Options → Blend If: Gray

1. Open Blending Options. This Layer responds to the skull's own brightness; Underlying Layer responds to the portrait below. In Benny's skull example, watch the split dark control on the Underlying Layer row.
2. Option-drag on Mac / Alt-drag on Windows to split a triangle and soften its transition. Move a small amount, inspect the image, then continue. For the black-background CC0 alternative, first use This Layer's black control to exclude the unwanted background; it is a different input problem.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 1:24

Both Blend If rows are visible. The pointer is at the lower, Underlying Layer dark control.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 1:27

The source shows the Underlying Layer dark transition split at0/180 in this moment. It is an observed setting for this source, not a universal recipe.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

WHY

Blend If selects a tonal relationship. A layer mask selects a location. They are different controls.

CHECK

You can name which image supplies the brightness test. The transition is gradual rather than a hard cut.

FIX

Reset the sliders if the wrong tones vanish. Do not copy a setting from the other row or from a different source image.

Method basis: B. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

SESSION 2 · LESSONS 2

Local masks, eyes and the optional jaw

Four short technique stages; pause for practice and repair before adding the next effect. Timing is an unmeasured teaching estimate, not a tested classroom duration.

05 Reveal selected bone; keep the colour believable

Recall first (from last lesson, no peeking):

1. What is the difference between a layer image and its mask?
2. Which Blend If row tests the source image?
3. Why restore opacity after aligning?

Say or write your answers, then check them against your file.

Source-demonstrated method; classroom directions below are an adaptation for your own image. Current installed-version click-by-click verification remains open.

DOCUMENT: Your layered NightShift portrait PSD
SELECT: Portrait PSD · SKULL layer mask, then SKULL blend mode
TOOLS / ROUTE: Layer → Layer Mask → Hide All; Brush; Layers blend-mode menu

1. Add a black mask to SKULL. Choose a soft white brush and reveal only the intended nose/socket/cheek region; use black to restore the original skin at unwanted edges. Keep the original portrait mask intact in the core route.
2. Set SKULL to Luminosity if you want its light–dark information with the underlying colour. Compare that with Normal. Match brightness separately with an editable correction; choose the mode that best matches your photo.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 1:32

A mask restricts the skull to chosen parts of the face.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 1:39

After: the skull is integrated locally, rather than covering the whole portrait.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

WHY

A local mask controls the anatomical reveal; Luminosity addresses colour contamination, not alignment.

CHECK

The face still belongs to one person and one lighting situation. The reveal has no square photo boundary.

FIX

A coloured cast needs colour/mode correction. Misplaced bone needs alignment. A hard rectangle needs a mask. Diagnose before adding more effects.

Method basis: B. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

06 Change the eyes with a masked adjustment

Source-demonstrated method; classroom directions below are an adaptation for your own image. Current installed-version click-by-click verification remains open.

DOCUMENT: Your layered NightShift portrait PSD
SELECT: Portrait PSD · EYES Levels adjustment and its mask
TOOLS / ROUTE: Layer → New Adjustment Layer → Levels; invert the adjustment mask

1. Add a Levels adjustment named EYES. To lift the darkest tones, move the black Output Levels control gently right. Select the adjustment's white mask and invert it to black: Cmd+I on Mac / Ctrl+I on Windows.
2. With the EYES mask selected, paint white only inside the intended eye region. Keep eyelids and nearby skin controlled. Stop before the eye becomes a flat white sticker.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 1:47

Before the local eye adjustment.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 2:02

After: a local Levels effect changes the eyes while surrounding skin remains readable.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

WHY

An adjustment changes tone; the mask limits where that change is visible.

CHECK

The eyes change while the forehead and clothing remain as before.

FIX

If the whole portrait changes, inspect the EYES mask. If nothing changes, check brush colour and whether you selected the mask.

Method basis: B. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

07 Optional: fit an external jaw

Source-demonstrated method; classroom directions below are an adaptation for your own image. Current installed-version click-by-click verification remains open.

Optional advanced route. Skip unless your source includes the required jaw/contour. The core local bone study does not require this.

DOCUMENT: Your layered NightShift portrait PSD
SELECT: Advanced route only · duplicate SKULL EXTERNAL Smart Object
TOOLS / ROUTE: Duplicate layer; Filter → Liquify → Show Backdrop

1. Use this extension only with an approved skull image that includes the lower jaw. Duplicate SKULL, name the copy SKULL EXTERNAL and remove the copied reveal mask from the duplicate only.
2. Open Liquify, show the portrait backdrop and adjust the jaw region to follow the person's jaw. Keep the rest of the skull irrelevant to this local extension. Commit only when the chosen jaw contour aligns.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 2:09

The source begins its advanced external-jaw extension.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 2:23

The source isolates the jaw geometry. This is not required for the included upper-skull practice asset.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

WHY

A photograph can supply a new contour, but its geometry still has to fit the subject.

CHECK

The jaw looks attached to the same head. No stretched teeth or duplicated contour dominates.

FIX

Skip this extension if the supplied skull lacks the jaw. Do not stretch the upper skull into a fictitious mandible.

Method basis: B. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

08 Optional: coordinate the jaw and subject masks

Source-demonstrated method; classroom directions below are an adaptation for your own image. Current installed-version click-by-click verification remains open.

Optional advanced route. Skip unless your source includes the required jaw/contour. The core local bone study does not require this.

DOCUMENT: Your layered NightShift portrait PSD
SELECT: Advanced route · SKULL EXTERNAL mask and SUBJECT mask
TOOLS / ROUTE: Layer Mask; Brush; named subject group

1. Mask SKULL EXTERNAL so only the needed jaw remains. Keep the working portrait and skull layers inside SUBJECT BUILD; retain the hidden original outside this working group.
2. Only in this advanced contour route, hide the original portrait areas that would cover the new jaw gap. Switch between the jaw mask and portrait mask deliberately. Inspect the result over two backgrounds and save a new PSD version.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 2:31

The jaw and the original face must share a coherent contour.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 2:41

The source edits the subject boundary around the inserted jaw.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

WHY

An insert reveal and a silhouette change are separate tasks. The core nose/socket route needs no silhouette hole.

CHECK

No original skin edge crosses the intended gap; no unrelated part of the person becomes transparent.

FIX

If the wrong region disappears, undo and read the selected layer name and mask thumbnail before continuing.

Method basis: B. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

SESSION 3 · LESSONS 3

Material placement and light modelling

Four short technique stages; pause for practice and repair before adding the next effect. Timing is an unmeasured teaching estimate, not a tested classroom duration.

09 Fit the first flesh texture to an opening

Recall first (from last lesson, no peeking):

1. When does the core route need no silhouette hole?
2. What does a black adjustment mask do?
3. What should stay editable after placement?

Say or write your answers, then check them against your file.

Source-demonstrated method; classroom directions below are an adaptation for your own image. Current installed-version click-by-click verification remains open.

DOCUMENT: Your layered NightShift portrait PSD
SELECT: Portrait PSD · FLESH Smart Object
TOOLS / ROUTE: File → Place Embedded; Edit → Transform → Warp

1. Place the approved food photograph and name it FLESH. Choose a small useful material region; exclude the plate, food preparation scene and rectangular background. Fit its grain to the intended opening.
2. Use Warp sparingly where a flat rectangle does not follow the contour. Add a layer mask and reveal only that small region. The provided Night Shift food photo is a different study source from the one shown in Benny's video.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 2:47

Before masking: the placed food photograph still overlaps unwanted areas.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 2:54

After fitting/masking: the material is confined to the opening.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

WHY

A source photo becomes a new material through crop, orientation, scale, visibility and light—not by pasting the whole photo.

CHECK

You see material within the opening, with no plate, square boundary or floating patch.

FIX

If it looks stretched, reduce the Warp and choose a crop whose original grain direction already fits.

Method basis: B. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

10 Match flesh value without making a black hole

Source-demonstrated method; classroom directions below are an adaptation for your own image. Current installed-version click-by-click verification remains open.

DOCUMENT: Your layered NightShift portrait PSD
SELECT: Portrait PSD · FLESH Smart Object or its clipped correction
TOOLS / ROUTE: Image → Adjustments → Levels on Smart Object; or clipped Levels adjustment

1. Match the insert's brightest and darkest tones to its surroundings. In the video, the Output Levels sliders compress the range; do not confuse these with the three Input Levels controls above.
2. Keep the centre textured while making the recess darker than its lit rim. Toggle the correction to identify its actual contribution. Use your photograph's result as the target, not an invented universal numeric recipe.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 2:59

The source Levels dialog is open while the insert is adjusted.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 3:06

After: compare the insert's value with the surrounding skin and rim.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

WHY

The same light must explain the original skin, the rim and the inserted material.

CHECK

The opening reads as recessed, but its material still has visible detail.

FIX

If it turns solid black, reduce the darkening. If it remains glaring, correct value before reducing photo opacity.

Method basis: B. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

11 Optional: put material behind the subject

Source-demonstrated method; classroom directions below are an adaptation for your own image. Current installed-version click-by-click verification remains open.

Optional advanced route. Skip unless your source includes the required jaw/contour. The core local bone study does not require this.

DOCUMENT: Your layered NightShift portrait PSD
SELECT: Advanced contour route · FLESH BACK copy beneath SUBJECT BUILD
TOOLS / ROUTE: Duplicate; move below group; Brightness/Contrast as Smart Filter

1. For an actual silhouette opening, duplicate the food layer and move the copy below the masked subject group. Name it FLESH BACK. Keep a separate mask so its boundary is controlled.
2. Darken the rear material to fit its sheltered position. Adjust only the intended subject-mask opening. In the core surface route, skip this step and leave the portrait intact.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 3:13

The source layer order includes a separate FLESH copy below the main subject.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 5:52

The video later revisits a conspicuous flesh edge and darkens/refines it.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

WHY
Front, opening and rear material need different visibility and lighting roles.

CHECK
The back material sits behind the contour instead of floating over it.

FIX
If it covers the face, inspect the layer order before changing its colour. Never erase the protected original.

Method basis: B. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

12 Sculpt sockets and cheeks with local darkening

Source-demonstrated method; classroom directions below are an adaptation for your own image. Current installed-version click-by-click verification remains open.

DOCUMENT: Your layered NightShift portrait PSD
SELECT: Portrait PSD · DARKEN Exposure adjustment mask
TOOLS / ROUTE: Layer → New Adjustment Layer → Exposure; black mask; soft brush

1. Add an Exposure adjustment named DARKEN and reduce exposure gently. Limit the correction to the intended subject/group. Invert its mask to black, then reveal it softly around the sockets and cheek hollows.
2. Use several light passes rather than a single black-looking stroke. Compare both sides of the face with the original light direction. Keep eyelids, nose edges and skin texture legible.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 4:34

The source paints local socket shading.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 4:47

After: socket and cheek structure are deeper; the whole face is not uniformly black.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

WHY

Local value modelling can change perceived facial structure without adding another texture photograph.

CHECK

You can identify the hollow and explain where light is being reduced.

FIX

If a dark ring appears, use a softer transition or weaker correction and repair the mask edge.

Method basis: B. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

SESSION 4 · LESSONS 4

Wrinkles and the crack study

Four short technique stages; pause for practice and repair before adding the next effect. Timing is an unmeasured teaching estimate, not a tested classroom duration.

13 Align wrinkle detail; borrow texture, not another identity

Recall first (from last lesson, no peeking):

1. Which surface is in front of the flesh insert?
2. What makes a recess convincing?
3. What is a clipping mask limiting?

Say or write your answers, then check them against your file.

Source-demonstrated method; classroom directions below are an adaptation for your own image. Current installed-version click-by-click verification remains open.

Optional detail-source route. Use your own approved wrinkle/detail photograph, or skip this extension. The source portrait is not supplied as a cleared classroom asset.

DOCUMENT: Your layered NightShift portrait PSD
SELECT: Portrait PSD · WRINKLES Smart Object
TOOLS / ROUTE: Place Embedded; temporary opacity; Free Transform

1. Choose an approved wrinkle/detail photograph with a useful face angle and light direction. Place it above the subject, name it WRINKLES and lower opacity temporarily to align the local brow/cheek detail.
2. Commit the transform and restore opacity. Select a small area for the texture; do not keep the second person's eyes, headwear, outer contour or entire face. The original video's linked portrait is a source reference, not a bundled cleared classroom asset.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 5:05

Before: the complete detail photograph has been placed.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 5:12

The source aligns its useful facial texture before revealing it locally.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

WHY

An effective texture transfer preserves the original character's structure and identity.

CHECK

The wrinkle direction follows the original face and no second eye or clothing feature shows.

FIX

If the face becomes someone else, reduce the reveal area rather than lowering the whole layer until it becomes ghosted.

Method basis: B. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

14 Blend and mask the wrinkles

Source-demonstrated method; classroom directions below are an adaptation for your own image. Current installed-version click-by-click verification remains open.

Optional detail-source route. Use your own approved wrinkle/detail photograph, or skip this extension. The source portrait is not supplied as a cleared classroom asset.

DOCUMENT: Your layered NightShift portrait PSD
SELECT: Portrait PSD · WRINKLES Blend If, mask and mode
TOOLS / ROUTE: Blending Options; Layer Mask → Hide All; Luminosity; Gaussian Blur if needed

1. Open Blend If and inspect This Layer's split tonal control in the source. Split transitions with Option/Alt; then use a black mask and white brush to reveal selected folds only.
2. Compare Luminosity with Normal, reduce opacity as needed and match sharpness to the portrait. Apply a small Gaussian Blur as a Smart Filter only when the inserted detail is visibly sharper than the underlying image.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 5:19

Source Blend If controls: read the This Layer row, not the Underlying Layer row.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 5:35

After local masking: original facial features remain; selected folds are more pronounced.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

WHY
Tone, location, colour and sharpness are separate matching decisions.

CHECK
The surface detail belongs to the same focus plane and does not replace the original landmarks.

FIX
A halo is not repaired by more saturation. Recheck tonal transition, mask edge and sharpness in that order.

Method basis: B. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

15 Choose a natural shape for a crack

Source-demonstrated method; classroom directions below are an adaptation for your own image. Current installed-version click-by-click verification remains open.

DOCUMENT: Your layered NightShift portrait PSD
SELECT: Portrait PSD · CRACK Smart Object
TOOLS / ROUTE: Place Embedded; Free Transform; source crop

1. Use an irregular dark opening or crease in an approved food/material photograph. Decide where it can follow the forehead's form; place and transform it before masking.
2. Keep only the source region that can explain the crack and surrounding material. Benny's supplied image is a goat-flesh photo; the local Night Shift meat photo is an alternative practice texture, not the same stock image.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 6:26

The creator points to a useful dark opening within a food photograph.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 6:33

The source then uses Blend If to reduce unwanted tonal regions before the local reveal.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

WHY

Selecting a source with the needed physical structure gives more convincing information than inventing a random dark blob.

CHECK

You can point to the source shape you want and explain its intended position on the face.

FIX

If the crop has no usable structure at its intended size, choose another region; do not enlarge a tiny crop until it becomes pixel blocks.

Method basis: B. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

16 Reveal and integrate the crack

Source-demonstrated method; classroom directions below are an adaptation for your own image. Current installed-version click-by-click verification remains open.

DOCUMENT: Your layered NightShift portrait PSD
SELECT: Portrait PSD · CRACK mask, mode and Levels
TOOLS / ROUTE: Hide All mask; white brush; Multiply; Levels Output controls

1. Add a black mask and reveal the crack locally. Compare Multiply with Normal. Multiply darkens the composite, so use it deliberately rather than assuming every inserted material needs it.
2. If the dark area is excessively black, lift the black Output Level slightly. The source frame shows17 for its own photograph; treat17 as an observed example, not a mandatory setting for yours. Refine the mask and reposition if needed.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 6:48

After: only the selected crack region is visible.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 6:56

The source Levels dialog shows a black Output Level of17 while moderating the recess.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

WHY

A tonal correction can reduce an over-dark composite while retaining the opening's shape.

CHECK

The crack has a readable rim/recess and no surviving source-photo rectangle.

FIX

If it still looks pasted, inspect scale, direction and mask boundary before adding more colour effects.

Method basis: B. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

SESSION 5 · LESSONS 5

Optional surface details and pallor

Four short technique stages; pause for practice and repair before adding the next effect. Timing is an unmeasured teaching estimate, not a tested classroom duration.

17 Optional: local bruise colour with a fill layer

Recall first (from last lesson, no peeking):

1. Which Levels controls set the darkest output?
2. What does Blend If do that a local mask does not?
3. How do you diagnose a pasted-photo border?

Say or write your answers, then check them against your file.

Source-demonstrated method; classroom directions below are an adaptation for your own image. Current installed-version click-by-click verification remains open.

DOCUMENT: Your layered NightShift portrait PSD
SELECT: Portrait PSD · BRUISE COLOUR fill and black mask
TOOLS / ROUTE: Layer → New Fill Layer → Solid Color; Overlay; Hide All mask

1. Choose a restrained dark red/brown fill, set Overlay and make its mask black. Reveal only a small bruise/rim area with a soft white brush. Keep this optional; a convincing character need not be bloody.
2. Reduce the fill layer's opacity until the underlying texture remains visible. Compare the result at normal viewing size and remove additions that distract from the chosen focal area.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 7:25

The source uses a separate masked colour-fill layer.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 7:32

After local painting: the change is limited rather than a red wash over the entire face.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

WHY

Colour should communicate the intended material and focal hierarchy rather than simply add intensity.

CHECK

The colour is local and skin detail remains visible beneath it.

FIX

If everything turns red, inspect the fill mask. If the fill becomes flat paint, compare the blend mode before lowering opacity.

Method basis: B. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

18 Optional: scratches from a real material

Source-demonstrated method; classroom directions below are an adaptation for your own image. Current installed-version click-by-click verification remains open.

DOCUMENT: Your layered NightShift portrait PSD
SELECT: Portrait PSD · SCRATCHES Smart Object and mask
TOOLS / ROUTE: Place Embedded; Blend If; Multiply; local mask

1. Choose a real scratched material photograph. Fit its grain to a small skin/clothing area, then use Blend If to suppress the unwanted light regions and compare Multiply.
2. Mask away the backing and reveal only useful marks. Keep scratches off the eyes and teeth unless they serve a deliberate, credible design decision. Existing paint photographs are a transfer option; they are not the wood source shown here.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 7:47

Before: the source material still covers a large region.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 7:54

After: the material has been restricted to local surface detail.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

WHY

An ordinary photographed material can supply useful texture once its backing and context are removed.

CHECK

No recognisable plank/rectangle remains; scale and orientation belong to the target surface.

FIX

If it looks like wood wallpaper, reduce the revealed area and match grain size before changing colour.

Method basis: B. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

19 Create pallor while preserving selected colour

Source-demonstrated method; classroom directions below are an adaptation for your own image. Current installed-version click-by-click verification remains open.

DOCUMENT: Your layered NightShift portrait PSD
SELECT: Portrait PSD · clipped Vibrance adjustment mask
TOOLS / ROUTE: Layer → New Adjustment Layer → Vibrance; clipping; mask

1. Add Vibrance above the intended subject stack and clip it to that subject/group. Reduce saturation gradually while comparing with the unmodified portrait.
2. Use the adjustment mask to preserve colour in chosen eyes, nose and material details. Read the clipping arrow and the mask thumbnail before painting.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 8:02

The source shows the Vibrance adjustment and its clipping relation.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 8:11

After desaturation: selected details retain colour while the overall skin becomes less lively.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

WHY

A global colour idea still needs local exceptions to keep materials and anatomy readable.

CHECK

The skin has less colour without turning all inserted materials and eyes into the same grey.

FIX

If the whole document changes, check the clipping/base layer. If a detail loses necessary colour, repair the adjustment mask.

Method basis: B. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

20 Make a small hue shift and check restraint

Source-demonstrated method; classroom directions below are an adaptation for your own image. Current installed-version click-by-click verification remains open.

DOCUMENT: Your layered NightShift portrait PSD
SELECT: Portrait PSD · clipped Hue/Saturation adjustment
TOOLS / ROUTE: Layer → New Adjustment Layer → Hue/Saturation; Master Hue

1. Add Hue/Saturation above the intended skin stack and clip it. Nudge Master Hue only slightly toward the ill green/yellow direction that fits your portrait; leave Colorize off unless you deliberately want a different effect.
2. Toggle before/after and compare at normal viewing size. Keep the forehead, cheek, ears and neck coherent. Stop when the colour supports the character rather than becoming a green face-paint layer.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 8:20

The source's overall hue has shifted while the local bone/flesh structure remains.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 8:35

The source checks the combined treatment on the whole face.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

WHY

The colour decision must integrate the effect with the person, not cover weak masking.

CHECK

The result reads as one subject; the hue shift does not conceal detail or replace value modelling.

FIX

If it looks painted, reduce the shift and check whether the clipping stack affects the intended layers.

Method basis: B. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

SESSION 6 · LESSONS 6

Lighting, finish and independent transfer

Four short technique stages; pause for practice and repair before adding the next effect. Timing is an unmeasured teaching estimate, not a tested classroom duration.

21 Unify the lighting around the figure

Recall first (from last lesson, no peeking):

1. Why can a colour correction need a local mask?
2. What tells you that a source texture is too large?
3. Which edit could you remove without weakening the image?

Say or write your answers, then check them against your file.

Source-demonstrated method; classroom directions below are an adaptation for your own image. Current installed-version click-by-click verification remains open.

DOCUMENT: Your layered NightShift portrait PSD
SELECT: Portrait PSD · SUBJECT BUILD group and masked darkening layer
TOOLS / ROUTE: Group working layers; local edge darkening

1. Group the working character layers. Set the presentation background, then add a controlled darkening layer/adjustment limited to the subject and initially hidden by a black mask.
2. Reveal soft darkening at edges that should receive less light. Preserve the face's focal area and match the direction of the original photograph. Black is the source creator's choice, not a requirement for your client.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 9:05

The source gathers its working treatment before final lighting.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 9:13

After: edge darkening supports a frontal-light impression against the dark background.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

WHY

A shared light direction makes separately sourced materials feel like one photographed scene.

CHECK

The subject separates from the background without an accidental glow or uniformly dark silhouette.

FIX

A halo usually needs edge/mask repair. Do not hide it with a thick black outline.

Method basis: B. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

22 Polish a separate composite; preserve the working layers

Source-demonstrated method; classroom directions below are an adaptation for your own image. Current installed-version click-by-click verification remains open.

DOCUMENT: Your layered NightShift portrait PSD
SELECT: Portrait PSD · new COMPOSITE FINISH Smart Object above the editable build
TOOLS / ROUTE: Stamp Visible; Convert to Smart Object; Filter → Camera Raw Filter

1. Save the layered file first. Create a new merged-visible copy above the working layers: Cmd+Option+Shift+E on Mac / Ctrl+Alt+Shift+E on Windows. Name it COMPOSITE FINISH; do not flatten the only master.
2. Convert this copy to a Smart Object and open Camera Raw Filter. Compare small clarity/texture/contrast changes at100% and at final size. Keep the effect subordinate to believable edges and material.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 9:32

A new merged-visible layer sits above the preserved source build.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 9:41

The source opens Filter → Camera Raw Filter on the finishing copy.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

WHY

A finishing pass can unify the result while the original construction remains available for revision.

CHECK

You can hide COMPOSITE FINISH and still inspect all original masks/adjustments below.

FIX

If the layers disappear, you flattened rather than stamped: undo and return to the last saved layered version.

Method basis: B. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

23 Optional focus effect, then export and reopen

Source-demonstrated method; classroom directions below are an adaptation for your own image. Current installed-version click-by-click verification remains open.

DOCUMENT: Your layered NightShift portrait PSD
SELECT: Portrait PSD · finishing Smart Object; exported image copy
TOOLS / ROUTE: Filter → Blur Gallery → Field Blur; File → Save As / Export As

1. Use Field Blur only when a depth-of-field change serves the image. Keep the focal eyes/effect region sharp and blur other areas cautiously; compare noise/grain with the sharp image rather than blurring all detail equally.
2. Save the layered PSD. Export an sRGB PNG/JPEG copy for the existing assignment, then reopen the PSD and exported image. Check masks, layers, edge quality, dimensions and the intended viewing size.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 10:10

The source places focus/blur controls locally.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

Demonstration · Benny Productions · 9:48

The source finishing controls show Clarity+54 at this moment. This is an observed example for the source photograph, not a prescribed classroom setting.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

WHY

A successful export must communicate the image and preserve an editable master for revision.

CHECK

The PSD retains layers and the output looks correct at its actual delivery size.

FIX

If the export is softer or has a colour shift, compare dimensions, profile and export settings with the master.

Method basis: B. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

24 Transfer the method: bark, paint or another material

Source-demonstrated method; classroom directions below are an adaptation for your own image. Current installed-version click-by-click verification remains open.

DOCUMENT: Your layered NightShift portrait PSD
SELECT: New local texture group on your own portrait/body detail
TOOLS / ROUTE: Learning Screen comparison; transform → tonal blending → mask → light match

1. Compare Learning Screen's bark placement with its integrated hand/forehead result. Identify the common method: fit real source texture, control tone/blending, mask its location and match the underlying form.
2. For a fresh attempt, use a different approved material or a new body region. Explain why its grain, scale and light suit that region. Keep the existing Night Shift paint/food study as an additional method, not a claim about what either source video did.

Demonstration · Learning Screen · 4:16

Before: the source places a real bark photograph near the hand.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

Demonstration · Learning Screen · 5:43

After: selected bark information has been integrated locally.

Open this exact point on YouTube · Internet required. Use the large player or full screen to inspect controls.

WHY

Transfer means using the control logic on a changed source/problem, not reproducing the creator's exact face.

CHECK

You can predict a change, select the correct control, test it and defend the visual decision without reading the recipe.

FIX

If you cannot explain the control choice, return to a small practice region before adding the effect to the final client image.

Method basis: L. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

INDEPENDENT TRANSFER · AFTER THE GUIDED CHECK

Meet a changed brief, not a recipe.

Keep the same learning targets. Choose one teacher-approved direction: a subtle film-festival survivor portrait; a weathered fictional character with no exposed flesh; an environmental surface transformation; or an equivalent original brief. Choose your own source region, audience and visual style.

1. Plan a main effect and a supporting effect. Explain the audience and intended focal area.
2. Build it on a new region/source with the directions closed. Show one mask decision, one tonal/colour integration decision and an editable master.
3. Diagnose a real mismatch. Record the intended result, observed problem, likely cause, one change and the test.
4. Receive one specific teacher/peer feedback point. Save a new version, make the revision and show what changed.
5. Demonstrate one control without following the steps, then explain why it fits the problem.

Keep: layered PSD, export, source credit list and a short before/after revision record. Hand in through the existing assignment identified by the teacher; this page saves practice checks locally and submits nothing.

If you are stuck

Reread the target/action → compare the demonstration and CHECK → try the FIX → ask a coach classmate to guide without doing your work → ask your teacher and show what you tried.

BEFORE YOU SUBMIT

Student QA.

- [ ] Inspect at100% and actual delivery size.
- [ ] Check alignment, rectangular borders, halos and repeated texture.
- [ ] Toggle each main effect and explain its contribution.
- [ ] Reopen the layered PSD and exported image.
- [ ] Preserve a first attempt, one feedback point and a visibly improved revision.

SOURCES AND AUTHORSHIP

Method references.

B Benny Productions · How to turn yourself into a zombie! (photoshop) ·5Nov2019 https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6aoC6IF87f4&t=0s

L Learning Screen · Skull Zombie Face Tutorial | Photoshop ·17Mar2019 https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=yXtJsLy9EUs&t=0s

A1 Adobe · Advanced blending options · current desktop reference https://helpx.adobe.com/photoshop/desktop/create-manage-layers/apply-layer-effects/use-advanced-blending-options.html

A2 Adobe · Non-destructive editing https://helpx.adobe.com/photoshop/desktop/create-manage-layers/create-layer-compositions/non-destructive-editing-techniques.html

Photo credits

Human Skull · George Hodan · CC0 Public Domain; practice alternative, not the video's original skull · source. Processed as stated in each caption.

Figures marked Illustration are drawn, not screenshots. Step values are starting points authored for this project. Draft for teacher review; not yet classroom-piloted.

Demonstrations are official YouTube players linked to the original creators: Benny Productions and Learning Screen (2019). No copied video frames, videos, music, creator portraits or unverified class photographs are distributed in this public package.

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